NSW RUGBY UNION









2025-2027

STRATEGIC PLAN

CARE, CONNECT AND UNIFY THE GAME IN NSW

ABOUT NSW RUGBY UNION

KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATOR

To achieve 25% growth in the number of Rugby participants in NSW by 2027.

OUR PURPOSE



Supporting our Clubs, Schools, Volunteers and communities to drive the growth of Rugby in New South Wales.

OUR MISSION



Make Rugby a sport of choice for everyone in New South Wales, while ensuring the game helps to address social issues, strengthen communities and create an inclusive environment.

KEY PILLARS

GREAT COMPETITION EXPERIENCES

Create exceptional experiences that ignite passion and excitement for everyone involved - players, coaches, officials, supporters, and volunteers alike.

GROWTH & ENGAGEMENT

Drive focused recruitment and retention programs that connect players, coaches, match officials and volunteers to clubs and schools.

SUSTAINABLE FUTURE

Manage our financial affairs to sustain financial security, whilst making a positive difference in communities.

OUR VALUES

RESPECT

ACCOUNTABILITY

UNITY

INCLUSION

POSITIVITY



NSW RUGBY UNION

PRIORITIES

PILLAR 1

1 GREAT COMPETITION EXPERIENCES

1.1 CLUB DEVELOPMENT

Provide education and support to club volunteers across NSW to help them grow and thrive in the long term.

1.2 COMPETITIONS & TOURNAMENTS

Assist rugby administrators to enhance capacity, drive growth and increase opportunities.

1.3 MATCH OFFICIALS

Create a positive environment for recruitment and retention which support all clubs and schools to have an accredited match official at every game.

1.4 WOMEN'S RUGBY

Renew the governance and competition structure of Women's Rugby to ensure it continues to support growth, participation and creates new opportunities for female players across the state.

1.5 PATHWAYS

Maintain high quality pathway opportunities which support talent identification and development, guiding players from grassroots to state and national honours.



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PRIORITIES

PILLAR 2

2 GROWTH & ENGAGEMENT

2.1 DEVELOP WORKFORCE

Strengthen the skills and capabilities of existing staff members and increase headcount in community rugby, enabling greater reach for development of the sport and prioritisation of targeted growth areas.

2.2 WESTERN SYDNEY

Drive the Western Sydney Plan to boost Rugby participation in Western Sydney creating a sustainable platform for growth.

2.3 WOMEN & GIRLS

Grow competitions and create new ones to ensure we build on the foundation set by our clubs and schools - and work with them - to ensure women and girls can participate in Rugby in all parts the state.

2.4 COACHES

Deliver quality coach education courses to support our clubs and schools to increase the number of coaches across NSW and enhance their skills and effectiveness.

2.5 MATCH OFFICIALS

Grow and develop the match official community across NSW by delivering quality education and support to clubs and schools, strengthening both participation and performance.

2.6 FACILITIES

Create a comprehensive facilities strategy and prioritisation plan which maximise the opportunities provided by The Rugby World Cup legacy funding to support the growth and development of the sport.

2.7 RUGBY FOR GOOD

Expand the number of ‘Rugby for Good’ Hubs across NSW to help unite communities, increase inclusion, promote health and wellbeing, and empower individuals through the transformative power of Rugby.





PRIORITIES

PILLAR 3

3 SUSTAINABLE FUTURE

3.1 CORPORATE PARTNERSHIPS & SPONSORSHIPS

Enhance support for NSWRU to build strong corporate partnerships, driving increased investment into Rugby across NSW.

3.2 NSW RUGBY TV

Drive a collaborative strategy for the growth of NSW Rugby TV, enabling clubs and schools to benefit from the increased viewership and profile through a high-quality streaming service that supporters can access.

3.3 CORPORATE & INDIVIDUAL DONORS

Continue to drive growth through a diversified fundraising strategy that engages both corporate partners (ESG / CSR) and individual donors to contribute to the investment into 'Rugby For Good'.

3.4 GOVERNMENT & GRANTS

Create a unified strategy to maximise opportunities to secure government funding and grants, ensuring we effectively pursue and grow revenue.

3.5 PROMOTE THE GAME

Develop a cohesive media and communications strategy which amplifies the reach and impact of all digital channels.



NSW RUGBY UNION

ENABLERS



Maintain a workplace culture which is highly-engaged, aligned to our core values and celebrates achievements to drive motivation and ongoing success.

Ensure clear, consistent and strategic communication to maintain stakeholder engagement, build trust, strengthen and deepen community.

Uphold transparent and accountable governance practices at both Board and management levels, ensuring ethical decision-making and integrity at all times.

Leverage data-driven insights to guide decision-making, enhance performance and support the continued growth of Rugby in NSW.

Ensure we meet budget targets and diversify revenue streams to support long-term growth and sustainability.

Strengthen and sustain partnerships with our affiliates, the NSW Waratahs and Rugby Australia to maximise mutual benefits and growth opportunities.

GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Build participation from the grassroots up, emphasising the importance of community engagement and creating ‘A Game for All’.

Clubs and competitions are the foundation of the game. They must be well-run with a strong focus on competition quality and positive club cultures.

Pathways need to be connected with clear routes that guide players, coaches and officials from grassroots to elite levels.

Ensure every dollar invested has a measurable positive impact, driving our success by directly contributing to the growth, development and sustainability of the game.

Operations must be financially responsible and strategically-aligned, focused on building sustainable growth for Rugby in NSW while maximising resources and opportunities.

Highlight Rugby’s values and benefits by sharing stories that inspire and engage both current and potential players, fans and partners.

Rugby is a game for all shapes and sizes and has a place for everyone. Rugby will strive for increased opportunities for inclusion so that anyone can participate throughout their whole life.



NSW RUGBY UNION



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THANK YOU

CARE, CONNECT AND UNIFY THE GAME IN NSW

At NSW Rugby Union, we recognise that the strength of our game lies in the partnerships we forge across all levels of the rugby community.

Our strategic plan is built on a commitment to working collaboratively with our valued affiliates and partners – including grassroots clubs, schools, affiliates, professional teams, and commercial partners. Together, we aim to create a connected, inclusive, and sustainable rugby ecosystem. By aligning our goals and sharing resources, we will strive to deliver the best outcomes for all involved, ensuring the continued growth and success of rugby across New South Wales.

RUGBY AU · NSW RUGBY WARATAHS · NSW RUGBY WOMENS · NSW RUGBY SCHOOLS · NSW RUGBY REFEREES · SRU · COUNTRY RUGBY UNION · SUBURBAN FOUR'N'TWENTY · NSW RUGBY JUNIORS